



LIMITLESS™ SERIES

BEYOND TRAUMA: BUILDING CAPACITY FOR PRESENCE AND CHOICE

VOLUME I

A Framework for Emotional Recovery and Personal Transformation

to help you regulate your nervous system and maximize the present moment experience.

Evidence-Based · Clinician-Designed · Self-Paced

EMDR · IFS · DBT · CBT · ACT · Attachment Repair

To the clinicians and mentors who showed me that healing is possible, to the clients who continue to prove it — and to the continual process of learning, unlearning, and remembering what it means to be human.

“UNTIL YOU MAKE THE UNCONSCIOUS CONSCIOUS,
IT WILL DIRECT YOUR LIFE, AND YOU WILL CALL IT FATE.”

— CARL GUSTAV JUNG

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This workbook is intended as a psychoeducational and self-reflection tool designed to complement, not replace, individual psychotherapy. The exercises are informed by evidence-based therapeutic modalities, including Eye Movement Desensitization and Reprocessing (EMDR), Internal Family Systems (IFS), Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT), Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT), and Acceptance and Commitment Therapy (ACT), and are offered to support emotional insight, self-understanding, and personal growth. *However, they are not intended as a substitute for professional clinical assessment, diagnosis, or treatment.*

This material is provided solely for educational and informational purposes and does not constitute psychotherapy, medical advice, mental health treatment, diagnosis, or crisis intervention. The content is designed to facilitate reflection and skill-building, but it is not intended to diagnose, treat, or cure any mental health condition.

If you are currently experiencing a mental health crisis, including thoughts of self-harm or suicide, severe dissociation, or are in an unsafe environment, please discontinue use of this workbook and seek immediate support from a licensed mental health professional, contact a crisis support service, or call 911 (or your local emergency services) if you are in immediate danger.

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If you are currently engaged in therapy, this workbook is intended to be used as an adjunct to that work. Bringing your reflections, insights, and responses into session is encouraged to support deeper processing and clinical integration.

About the Author

My path to this work was anything but traditional—and I believe that is exactly what makes it different.

I began my career in finance at Merrill Lynch, later transitioned into the legal field, and built an 18-year career working within complex, high-stakes corporations. Along the way, I earned a Master's degree in Clinical Psychology from Pepperdine University, where I developed the clinical foundation that informs everything in this workbook. Today, I serve as Chief Operating Officer of a litigation law firm, consulting with organizations on strategy, operations, and long-term sustainability. Across every environment I have worked in—from boardrooms to courtrooms to therapy rooms—I noticed a common pattern:

The most intelligent, accomplished, and capable people were often being quietly directed by emotional and physiological patterns they did not fully understand.

Their decisions, relationships, confidence, and sense of self were being influenced by experiences their nervous systems had learned long ago—and were still responding to in the present. Eventually, I realized the same was true for me. What followed was not a dramatic breaking point, but a gradual recognition that I had spent years mastering external systems while leaving my internal one largely unexplored. I spent years trying not to feel “too much”, only to learn that feeling is part of being fully alive. The contrast of our experiences is what makes us human. I approached the challenge of learning how to feel with curiosity, persistence, and a deep commitment to understanding what was happening beneath the surface.

The result was a deep immersion into the science of trauma, attachment, nervous system regulation, memory reconsolidation, and psychological change—not only as a clinician, but as a participant in the work itself. *This workbook reflects that journey.*

The frameworks you will find here are grounded in evidence-based approaches including EMDR, attachment theory, Internal Family Systems (IFS), Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT), Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT), Acceptance and Commitment Therapy (ACT), and contemporary neuroscience. They have also been shaped by years spent studying how people change, why they get stuck, and what allows meaningful transformation to endure.

My mission is simple:

To make the most powerful tools in modern psychology accessible to people who are ready to understand themselves more deeply and create lasting change.

I continue to believe that vulnerability is one of the hardest—and most courageous—things we are asked to practice. This work is not passive, and it is not soft. It requires honesty, self-reflection, and the willingness to examine the patterns that once operated automatically. Yet the rewards are profound: a greater capacity for awareness, choice, and freedom.

The freedom to respond from who you are becoming rather than react from what you have survived.

— Tiffani Sainz, MA, AMFT

EMDR-Informed Trauma Therapist & Executive Leader

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Why This Workbook Exists

We will be exploring the underlying causes and conditions that shape your experiences and current circumstances. While the term “trauma” has become widely used in recent years, our focus is not on labels, but on understanding what may be contributing to feelings of being “stuck” while inviting new perspectives on your current internal patterns/internal software.

The intention is to build a clear and compassionate foundation of self-awareness in relation to your emotional responses, behaviors, and experiences.

I also want to share something personal, so you understand who is guiding you through this work. I have experienced this process both as an EMDR client and as a clinician. I have sat on both sides of the therapeutic relationship. Through my own work in therapy, self-exploration, and honest self-assessment, I have seen firsthand how transformative this kind of inner work can be — not just in emotional healing, but in mental clarity and decision-making. I am in this process with you, not outside of it, and this workbook reflects both my clinical training and my lived experience of what it means to do the work.

With that, let’s begin the discovery process.

This workbook is designed to help you identify, understand, and update these patterns using six of the most evidence-based therapeutic approaches available.

Trauma becomes a physiological prediction system — one that shapes how your nervous system interprets the present moment, often long after the original threat has passed.

Many people find themselves reacting to current situations as though past threats are still occurring: a raised voice that sparks shutdown, intimacy that triggers panic, success that brings dread. This is not weakness — it is your nervous system doing exactly what it was trained to do.

This Workbook Helps You

EMDR Framework	Reprocess stored emotional memory so the past stops living in your body.
Internal Family Systems	Understand your protective parts and reduce internal conflict.
Dialectical Behavior Therapy	Build the emotional regulation skills that keep you grounded.
CBT + Somatic Awareness	Rewire the threat prediction systems running in the background.
Acceptance & Commitment Therapy	Strengthen psychological flexibility and values-aligned living.
Relational Neuroscience	Repair the attachment injuries that shaped how you love and connect.

The goal is not to erase the past. The goal is to reduce your nervous system's tendency to misclassify safety as danger — so you can respond from the present rather than react from the past.

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SAFETY & READINESS CHECK

Before beginning, assess your current level of stability

Trauma processing is most effective — and safest — when you have a stable foundation to return to. Use this page to check in with yourself honestly before proceeding.

Rate Each Item (0 = None | 10 = Extreme)

CURRENT DISTRESS LEVEL:

ABILITY TO RETURN TO CALM AFTER ACTIVATION:

FEELING GROUNDED IN PRESENT REALITY:

Resources I Can Use When Activated

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ 5-4-3-2-1 Grounding | ☐ Cold Water / Sensory Reset |
| ☐ Orienting to Environment | ☐ Walking or Movement |
| ☐ Stretching | ☐ Deep Breathing |
| ☐ Calling a Support Person | ☐ Journaling |
| ☐ Box Breathing | ☐ Other: _____ |

NOTES:

Clinician Note: If distress consistently reads above 7, prioritize stabilization and emotional regulation skills using the above resources before engaging in intensive trauma processing.

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INTERNAL FAMILY SYSTEMS (IFS) PARTS CHART

Identify your managers, firefighters & exiles

Internal Family Systems (IFS) understands that we are made up of multiple parts, each with a protective role. Many of our most frustrating emotional reactions are actually protective parts working very hard to keep our most vulnerable selves safe.

Manager Part	Proactive protectors that try to prevent pain from ever occurring. Perfectionists, people-pleasers, inner critics.
Firefighter Part	Reactive protectors that spring into action when pain breaks through. Substance use, rage, dissociation, compulsions.
Exiled Child Part	The vulnerable parts carrying core wounds, shame, and unmet needs — often frozen in time.

MY MANAGER PART (NAME IT IF YOU CAN):

MY FIREFIGHTER PART:

MY EXILED CHILD PART:

WHAT IS EACH PART TRYING TO PROTECT ME FROM?
